

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

PAYSON, ARIZONA · TURDAS, THE 1ST OF FROSTFALL (THURSDAY, OCTOBER 1, 2026)

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The Hearth's chicken, basking in the Frostfall sun — one wing up for shade.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

79° / 56°

Sunny

Sunrise 6:20 AM · Sunset 6:09 PM

Tomorrow — Sunny, 81/54

OVERHEARD AT THE MEAD HALL LAST NIGHT

A fair-goer swears something tall and hairy stood in the pines above the grounds, counting the pies on the bake-table — twice, careful as a tax man. The barkeep only shrugged: "Aye. Even the woods come down for fair week."

AROUND THE HOLDS · THE WEEK AHEAD

Fair Week: County Fair Opens, a Faire Village at the Golf Course



Payson, Ariz.



Fair week beneath the Rim: the County Fair's rodeo grounds and the Highland village, side by side.

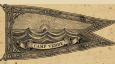
HAIL, fair-wayfarers, and a bright good morning to thee! Frostfall (the lowlanders — our Valley Dwellers up from the southern vale — call it "October", a mouth-

ful of a name for a month that smells of pine and kettle corn!) opens with a clear sky, a sun-warmed deck, and the biggest weekend of the year: the 72nd Annual Northern Gila County Fair throws its gates wide today at the

Payson Event Center, and tomorrow the North Inch Renaissance Faire raises a Scottish village on the Payson Golf Course fairways. Bulls, bagpipes, fiddles, and funnel cake — by the Nine, Rim Country has outdone itself. Below: what's on today in every Hold, the days ahead, the Hearth's own quests, and a diner where the iron drakes come home to roost.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY

-  **Payson**
 - **72nd Annual Northern Gila County Fair & B.U.C.K.L.E. Festival** — opens 9 AM, Payson Event Center, 1400 S Beeline Hwy; opening ceremony “Hailing Our Heroes” this evening, Rim Country plays 7:30 PM
 - **Morning at the Library** — Let's Talk Spanish 9 AM, Toddler Time 10:30 AM, Line Dancing 1:45 PM, Payson Public Library, 328 N McLane Rd — [monthly calendar](#)
 - **Rumsey Park Battle** — disc golf league round, 4:15–6:30 PM, Rumsey Park Disc Golf Course

-  **Camp Verde**
 - **Citizenship Class** — 6–7:30 PM, Camp Verde Community Library, 130 Black Bridge Rd; free weekly class, call (928) 554-8398

-  **Sedona**
 - **Sedona Yoga Festival** — opening day, from 12 PM, Outbound Sedona, 1752 AZ-179; runs through Sunday
 - **Hillside Morning Soundbath** — 10 AM, 671 AZ-179; alchemy crystal singing bowls, \$44

-  **Prescott**
 - **Perfect Poise AZ Cruise to the Pines** — classic car gathering from 12 PM, Watson Lake, Watson Lake Park Rd



Rumsey Park — wooden discs on the wing, hunting the iron ring among the pines.

THE DAYS AHEAD

- **Fredas, 2nd of Frostfall (Fri, Oct. 2)**

— **North Inch Renaissance Faire** — the inaugural

Scottish village opens 9 AM–5 PM on the Payson Golf

Course, 1504 W Country Club Dr. Artisans, combat demonstrations, axe throwing and archery, the Queen of Scots' court, and a stranger with a queer wind-spell device that wails like a heartbroken mammoth (other travelers have called it a “bagpipe”). \$8 adults, \$4 children, active-duty military free.

— **County Fair, Day Two** — the fair runs on at the Payson Event Center with bull riding at 6 PM and Moonshine Mafia on stage at 8 PM. Livestock shows, the Arizona State Fiddle Festival, mini-carnival rides, and vendors all day — arrive hungry and stay for the music.

— **First Friday in the Galleries** — Sedona's monthly art evening runs 4–7 PM at Tlaquepaque Arts & Shopping Village, 336 AZ-179. Gallery receptions, live music, and wine tastings, with the artists themselves on hand — a fine evening stroll as the Valley Dwellers trade the lowland heat for red-rock air.

— **Prescott Area Artist Studio Tour** — opens Friday, 10 AM–4 PM, and runs all weekend: 74 artists across 52 private studios and three art centers, free and self-guided. Watch the makers at their benches and take home a one-of-a-kind piece.



The Highland village rises on the long green — ropes taut, tents climbing, and one bagpipe tuning its heartbroken-mammoth wail. The goat approves of the rope.

- **Loredas, 3rd of Frostfall (Sat, Oct. 3)**

— **County Fair, Final Day** — the 72nd Annual Northern Gila County Fair & B.U.C.K.L.E. Festival closes out Saturday at the Payson Event Center: Western Fusion Band at 2:30 PM, Kristen Merlin headlining at 8 PM, the Junior Livestock Auction, ranch rodeo, and barrel racing. One last day of dust, fiddles, and fair food — don't let thy guests miss it.

— **North Inch Renaissance Faire, Day Two** — the Highland village runs its longest day, 9 AM–9 PM at the Payson Golf Course. The Clan Armstrong fire-dancers, the Pirate Queen Scarlett McBayne, and the Queen of the Faeries hold court — send the Valley Dwellers up early for the jousts and let them linger past dusk.

— **42nd Folk Music Festival** — returns to the Sharlot Hall Museum, 415 W Gurley St, Prescott, 9 AM–5 PM after a seven-year rest. More than 50 musicians across four stages, food trucks, and a new Kid Zone; admission \$15, kids 9 and under free — bring lawn chairs.

— **Pine-Strawberry Fall Festival & October Craft Show** — handcrafts fill the community center ramada, 3886 N Highway 87, Pine, Saturday 8 AM–5 PM and Sunday 8 AM–4 PM. Pumpkin patch and hayrides round out the fall tradition; grounds are alcohol- and smoke-free.

— **Twice Nice Fall Thrifty & Farmers Market Finale** — Camp Verde's thrift celebration runs 10 AM–2 PM at 527 S Main St with raffles, food trucks, and live music from Kaleidoscope Redrocks, while the Verde Valley Farmers Market closes its 2026 season 8–11 AM at 75 E Hollamon St. One last morning of fresh local produce before the stalls sleep till spring.

• Sundas, 4th of Frostfall (Sun, Oct. 4)

— **North Inch Renaissance Faire, Final Day** — the Scottish village's last stand runs 9 AM–5 PM at the Payson Golf Course. If thy guests have not yet seen the combat demonstrations or paid court to the Queen of Scots, Sundas is their final chance this year — haste ye back!

— **Sedona Community Farmers Market** — Sunday 8 AM–12 PM at 2201 W State Route 89A (Wells Fargo Bank parking lot), West Sedona. Local and seasonal harvest, artisan goods, and live music — a gentle morning after a weekend of fairs.

• Tirdas, 6th of Frostfall (Tue, Oct. 6)

— **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — lend thy back to the PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction crew, Tuesday 7 AM–noon, off Highway 87 just before Pine. Volunteers clear brush, move rocks, and shape new community trails; tools provided — bring water, sunscreen, gloves, and work shoes, and RSVP trails@psfuelreduction.org.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — measure the flame bulb and socket, then find or design the wall-torch sconce model.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Due Loredas, Oct. 3 — print two torches plus the socket test piece; test-fit the bulb and socket first.

The sconce design is overdue and the printing must fire by Loredas — the Hearth's torchlight waits on thee.



The craftsman at his bench, where the Hearth's torch sconces take shape.



Green Valley Park — still water and pine shade, with the Rim standing guard.

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

Crosswinds Restaurant · Payson



Pie first, iron drakes second — Crosswinds feeds both kinds of traveler.

Crosswinds is the beloved diner at Payson Airport, where the windows look straight down the landing-meadow — a long mown field the lowlanders call a “runway” — and the great iron drakes, held aloft by a clever levitation spell (or so the barkeeps swear), come and go while you eat. Drake-barns line the meadow’s edge, and a striped wind-serpent (other travelers call it a “windsock”) wriggles atop its pole, sniffing the breeze for the riders, who will not stir without its counsel. The regulars add that if that truly is a sock, they have no wish to meet the giant it would fit — whether it be windy or not. All morning the valley drakes come lumbering up from the lowlands with Valley Dwellers in their bellies, bound for pie: any drake can leap off the meadow — it is the landing that tries a rider’s soul, though at Crosswinds every landing ends, happily, at breakfast. Inside: all-day breakfast — chicken-fried steak and eggs, biscuits and gravy, burgers, and homemade pies worth crossing the valley for. Try the chocolate cream pie; pilots have flown in for it for generations.

“The food was really good but the pie...wow. The pie was amazing.” — [Birdeye review](#)

800 W Airport Rd Ste B, Payson, AZ 85541 — open daily 6 AM–3 PM (Fridays till 4 PM); (928) 474-1613; \$ inexpensive; it fills up on fair-weekend mornings, so go early and ask what pies came out of the oven. · [their scrying-mirror page](#) ([other travelers call it a ‘website’](#))

Why the Hearth sends you:

Breakfast beside the drakes’ landing-meadow and the best pie in the Hold — send thy guests at dawn, before the fair gates open, and they’ll thank thee before the first bull bucks.

TALES FROM THE TREELINE

EARL’S LAUNDRY SERVICE



One elk, two shirts, and a sheet bound for Scotland.

The sun came out grand on Turdas morning, and Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) took one look at his dripping wash line and had what he called a notion.

“Earl,” he announced, “you’re the tallest rack in the Hold.”

Earl (an elk with enormous antlers) stood very still, which everyone took for agreement. By mid-morning his antlers wore two shirts, a row of socks, and one magnificent sheet billowing like a sail bound for Scotland, that mist-shrouded realm across the eastern sea.

Henny (the Hearth’s plump chicken) inspected the work, claimed the sunniest sock for a throne, and refused to move for anything short of corn.

It might have worked, too, if the sheet hadn’t caught a proper gust: Earl took two dignified steps sideways, wearing the whole laundry like a very embarrassed ship.

Mabel (a wood elf) sighed the sigh of a woman who has folded this exact wash before. “Next time,” she said, “we ask the elk first.”

Earl has not commented. The sheet, however, is dry.

